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consecutive draws against high-flying Nottingham Forest and a floundering Manchester United. Bruno Fernandes scored from a free-kick for the Red Devils while Declan Rice’s strike in the second period meant the spoils were shared. The result helped United end a four-game losing streak against the Gunners in the league.

Forest, the season’s surprise

Premier League leaderboard

Player	Appearances	Goals
Alan Shearer	441	260
Harry Kane	320	213
Wayne Rooney	491	208
Andrew Cole	414	187
Mohamed Salah*	292	184
Sergio Aguero	275	184

package, cranked up its chances of securing a Champions League spot next season with a statement win against a struggling Manchester City. The defending champion showed glimpses of its original self during the 1-0 win against Tottenham Hotspur in midweek but was undone against Forest by a late strike from Callum Hudson-Odoi.

Hudson-Odoi’s goal ensured that his former club Chelsea crept into the top four, above City, after convincing wins against relegation-threatened Southampton and Leicester City.

La Liga

FC Barcelona maintained its grip on the top spot after effortlessly dispatching 10-man Real Sociedad 4-0. Gerard Martin and Marc Casado

scored their first-ever league goals while Ronald Araujo and Robert Lewandowski added to the tally. However, the Catalans’ hopes of taking a distinctive lead at the top were cut short after their match against Osasuna was postponed following the passing of first-team doctor Carles Minarro García.

However, they remained in first place after title challengers Real Madrid and Atletico Madrid suffered shock defeats in a span of days. Real Betis’ Isco (**above, right**) came back to haunt his former club Madrid and converted the winner from the spot to scrape away a 2-1 win. Los Blancos returned to winning ways against Rayo Vallecano the following week, with Kylian Mbappe and Vinicius Jr. finding the back of the net.

On the other hand, their city rival